

Performance Max portfolio growth

A controlled cross-channel extension to the Search portfolio

PORTFOLIO EXERCISE - NOT CLIENT WORK

QUESTION

How should Performance Max add reach without obscuring the intent structure already owned by Search?

DECISION

Use a governed feed, one coherent asset group, complete creative coverage, and audience signals as inputs.

EVIDENCE RETAINED

Merchant setup, asset-group logic, headline inventory, sitelinks, and audience-signal design.

VALIDATION

Reconcile channel overlap, feed health, search-term insights, conversion value, and incremental lift.

SECTION 1

Campaign Setup & Merchant Feed Configuration

Setting up a Performance Max campaign to run alongside the existing Search portfolio, reaching Search, YouTube, Display, Discover, Gmail, and Maps from a single build.

Asset group

Show high quality ads to the right people. Start by adding your assets, the building blocks of every ad. Google will test different combinations to create high performing ads across the formats and networks that work best for your goals and the audiences you want to reach.

Asset group name

All Products - Core Creat

Final URL

Final URL
<https://www.apple.com/iphone/>

Brand guidelines

Control how your brand appears in ads for this campaign. [Learn more about brand guidelines](#)

☒ Business name ⓘ

Apple
Required 5 / 25

☒ Logos 5/5 ⓘ

[Edit](#)

Add more for variety ⓘ

View more

More options
Add visual and text guidelines

Fig. 2: Asset group screen showing the group name 'All Products - Core Creative' and the Final URL pointed at the iPhone product page.

BEHIND THE STRATEGY

I named the asset group All Products - Core Creative and pointed the Final URL at the main iPhone page rather than a category or landing hub. PMax doesn't have keywords or ad groups the way a Search campaign does, the asset group is the whole structure, so getting the name and URL right at this stage matters more here than it would in a Search build, since every headline, description, and sitelink that follows gets tested against this one foundation.

Assets

Google AI isn't able to generate assets for your final url. You can still add assets yourself.

Ad strength Average

Images ☒ Headlines ☒ Sitelinks ☐
Videos ☐ Descriptions ☐

Headline (15) You have enough headlines to reach Excellent ad strength

Official Apple® Store	21 / 30
Upgrade to iPhone & Mac	23 / 30
Next-Gen Performance	20 / 30
Trade In & Save Today	21 / 30
Free & Fast Business Delivery	29 / 30
Shop Latest Apple Hardware	26 / 30
Seamless Ecosystem Setup	24 / 30
Power Your Business Workflows	29 / 30
Get Trade-In Instant Credit	27 / 30
Explore MacBook Pro & Air	25 / 30
Unmatched Speed & Power	23 / 30
Official Apple Warranty	23 / 30
Easy 1-Step Data Transfer	25 / 30
Custom Fleet Configurations	27 / 30
Buy Direct From Apple	21 / 30

Generate headlines

You've added the maximum number of headlines

- + Upgrade to the Latest iPhone
- + Trade In Your Old Phone
- + The Ultimate Business Tool

Select all [View more](#)

Long headlines (5) You have enough long headlines to reach Excellent ad strength

Experience Unmatched Speed & Power with the Latest Apple Hardware.	66 / 90
Upgrade Your Workspace with Custom-Configured Mac and iPhone Device	69 / 90
Trade In Your Current Devices and Get Instant Credit Toward Your Upgrade	73 / 90
Supercharge Enterprise Productivity with Powerful Apple Hardware & MDM	71 / 90
Discover Seamless Connectivity Across iPhone, Mac, and iPad Ecosystems	71 / 90

Preview Share View more

Search ad

Previews shown here are examples and don't include all possible formats. You're responsible for the content of your ads. Please make sure that your provided assets don't violate any Google policies or applicable laws, either individually, or in combination. Use of generative AI is subject to the [Google Terms of Service](#) and the [Generative AI Prohibited Use Policy](#).

Fig. 3: Assets screen showing all 15 short headlines and 5 long headlines filled in, with Ad Strength rated Excellent.

BEHIND THE STRATEGY

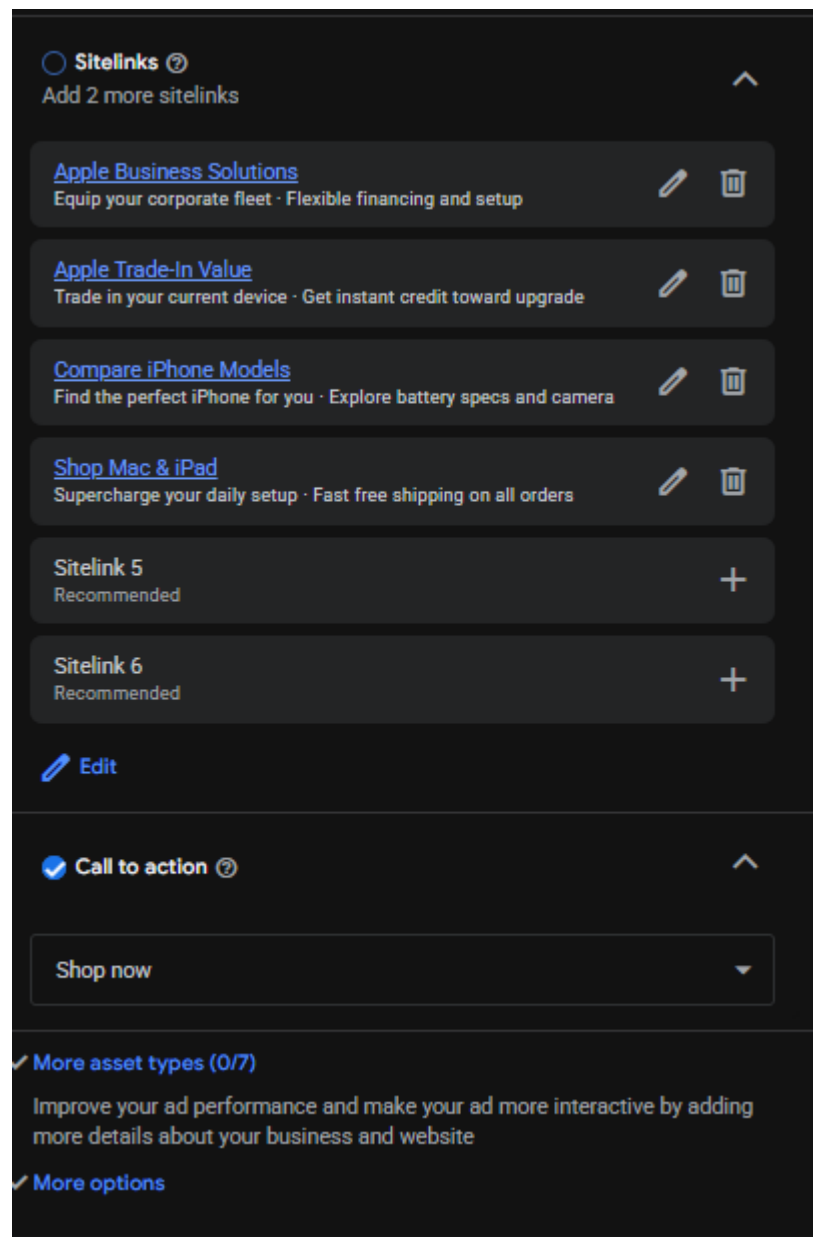


Fig. 4: The complete set of four sitelinks: Apple Business Solutions, Apple Trade-In Value, Compare iPhone Models, and Shop Mac & iPad.

BEHIND THE STRATEGY

Compare iPhone Models and Shop Mac & iPad cover someone still deciding what to buy, Apple Trade-In Value speaks to the cost-conscious upgrader, and Apple Business Solutions pulls in the same enterprise angle used in the B2B Search campaign. Keeping the same four themes consistent across channels means a person who saw the Search ad and later sees this one on Display or YouTube gets a familiar set of options, not a disjointed one.

SECTION 8

Audience Signals for AI Targeting

Feeding the algorithm a starting signal rather than a hard targeting rule, since that's how PMax actually uses this input.

Signals

Signals provide valuable information about the people you want to reach. They help guide who sees your ads on Google Search, YouTube, and more.

Search themes

What words or phrases would people use to search for your business?

Add search themes (4 of 50)

- apple hardware deals
- upgrade to iphone
- macbook pro custom spec
- best workstation for creative pros

Add search themes (up to 50)

Audience signal

Reach the right customers faster across Google with an audience signal.

Add saved audience signal

Your data First-party data can help us reach your customers

Interests & detailed demographics

Add any interests, detailed demographics, or life events related to your customers

Consumer Electronics	In-market	
Mobile Phones	In-market	
Laptops & Notebooks	In-market	

Add in-market segments, life events, and more

Demographics All demographics (recommended)

Audience name

Add a name for your audience to save it to your library (optional)

PMAX - Switchers & Tech Buyers Signal

Back Next

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Fig. 5: Signals screen showing the search themes built for the 'PMAX - Switchers & Tech Buyers Signal.'

BEHIND THE STRATEGY

I set search themes around apple hardware deals, upgrade to iphone, macbook pro custom spec, and best workstation for creative pros, paired with in-market audiences for consumer electronics, mobile phones, and laptops. Unlike the keyword lists in the Search campaigns, none of this is a strict match rule, a signal only tells